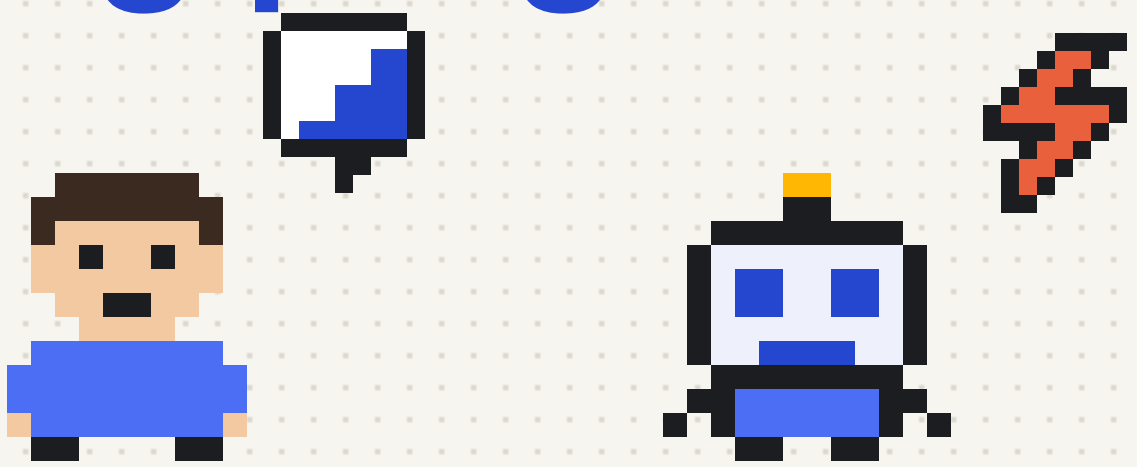
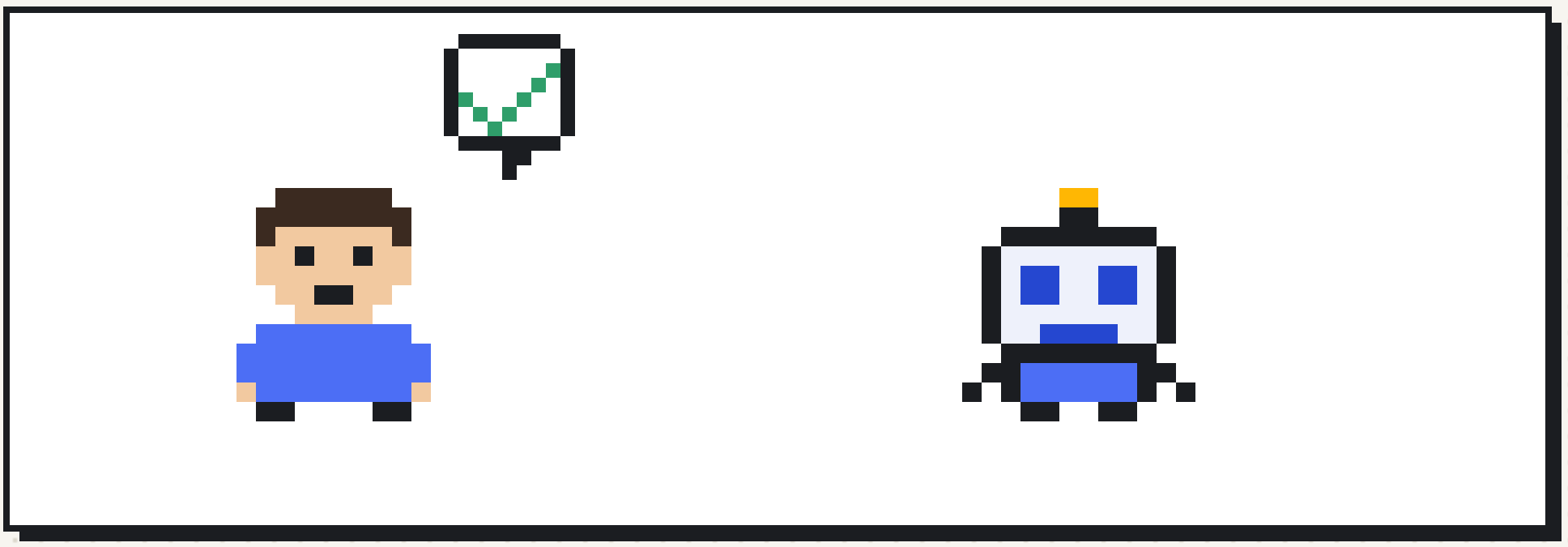
# A simulator is not a training program.



AI can now play the patient, the client, the customer, the opposing counsel.

Four things turn practice into skill.

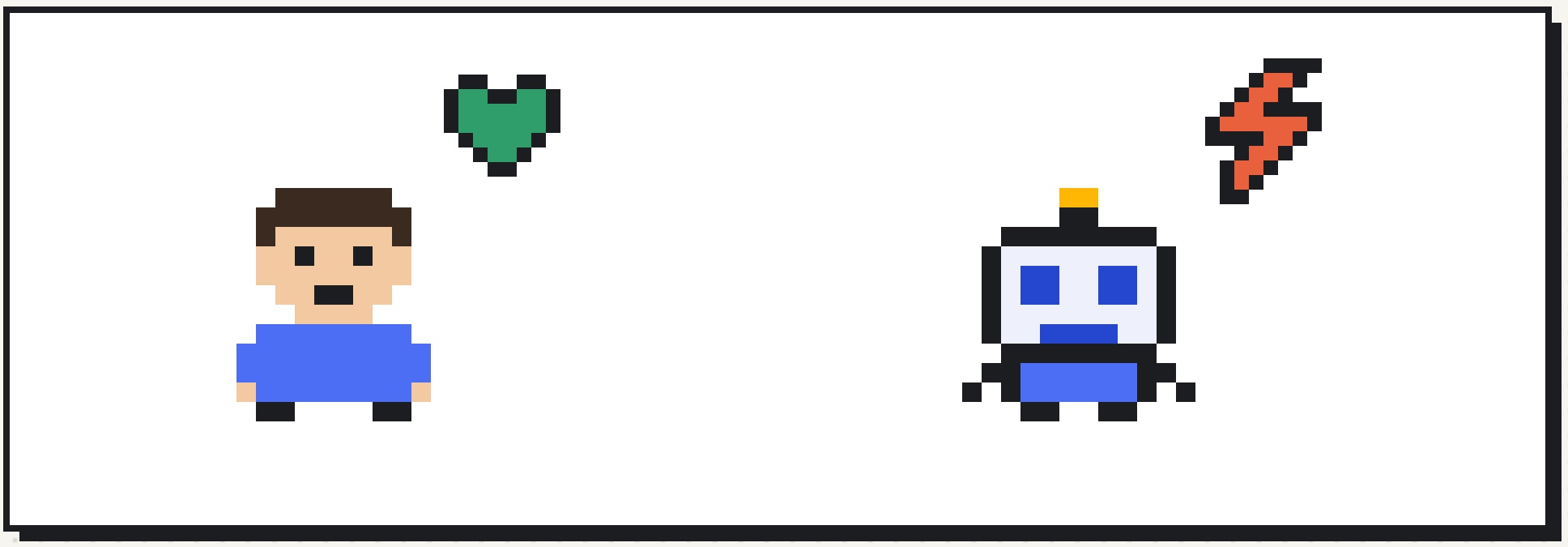
# Feedback, not just reps.



**Counselors who practiced with an AI patient alone got less empathetic. With AI feedback added, their core skills improved.**

Louie et al., CHI 2026 (Stanford), 94 novice counselors

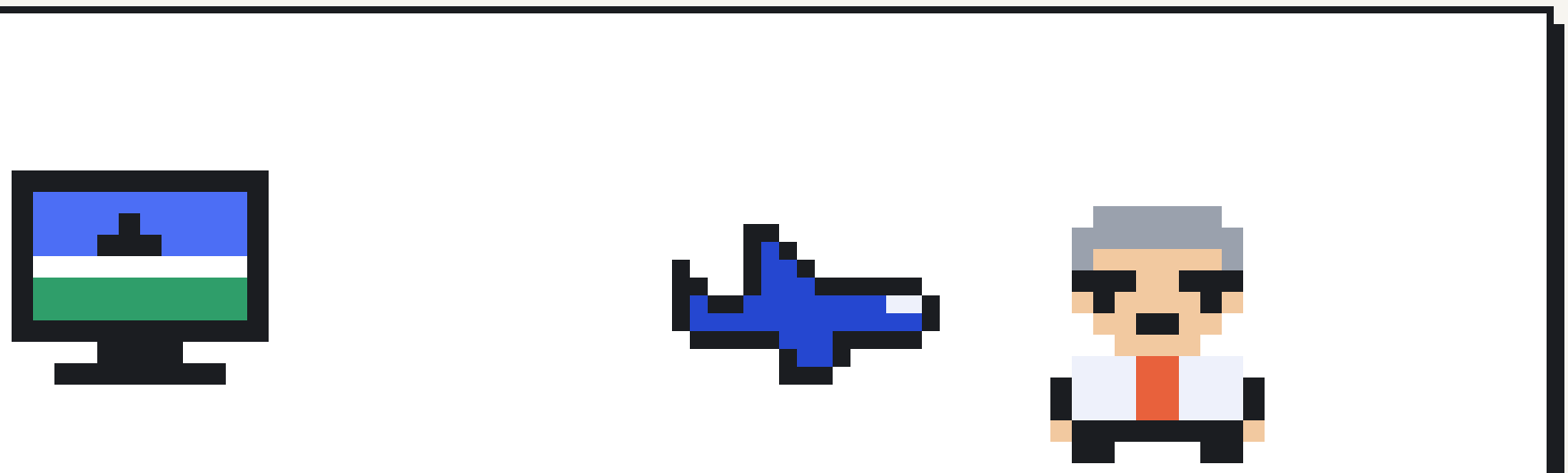
# Rehearse the hard moment.



**After practicing a conflict with an AI opponent: 67% fewer escalating tactics than a lecture group, and twice the cooperative ones.**

Shaikh et al., CHI 2024 (Stanford), 40 participants

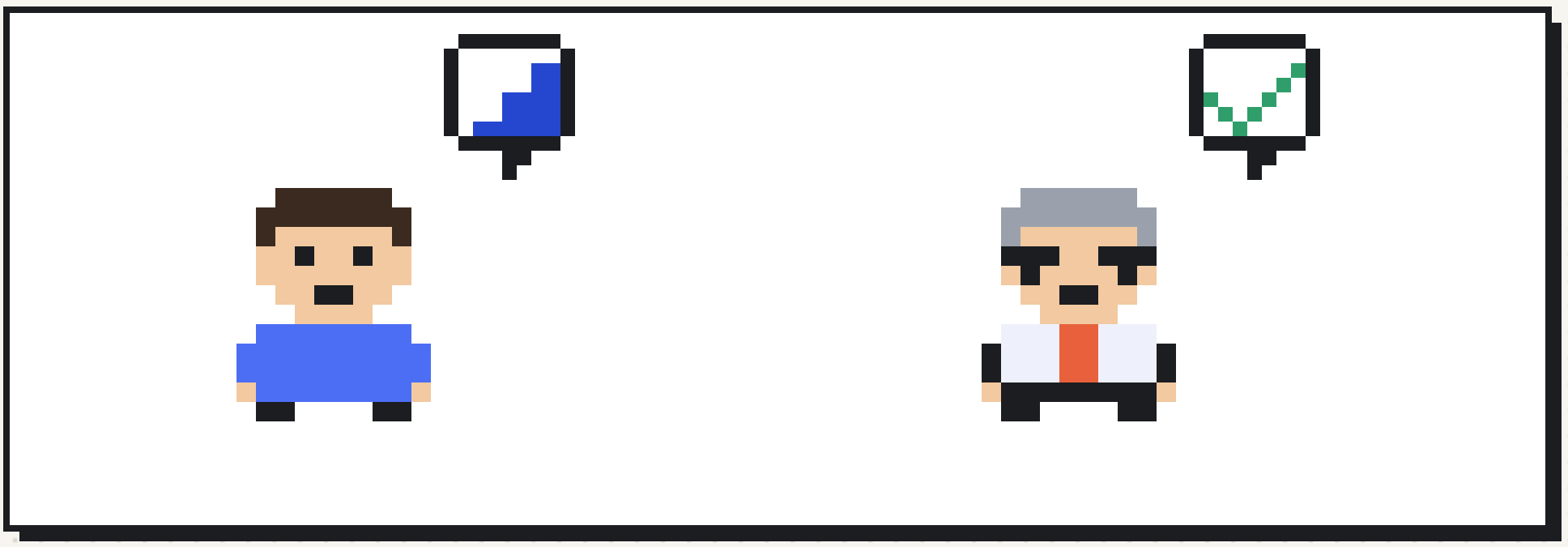
# Then a check pilot.



**After the simulator, airline pilots still fly real flights with a check pilot beside them. The rules don't let the simulator replace it.**

14 CFR 121.434 and Appendix H to Part 121

# Measure the skill, not the hours.



**Score what someone can do afterward, without the simulator. Hours inside it are not a learning outcome.**

Design recommendation drawn from the studies above

# Who plays the coach?

**AI can play the patient, the client, and the customer.**

**Should the feedback come from the AI, the instructor, or both?**

Tell me in the comments.